

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 44)

Page 217 - The Age of Tennyson (1832-1887)

Q1. Chapter 22 deals with the Age of Tennyson, covering which years?

- A. 1798-1832
- B. 1832-1887
- C. 1887-1914
- D. 1850-1900

Answer: B

Q2. The period called the Age of Tennyson corresponds very closely in general history with which era?

- A. The Elizabethan Age
- B. The Augustan Age
- C. The Victorian Age
- D. The Romantic Age

Answer: C

Q3. Queen Victoria ascended the throne in what year?

- A. 1832
- B. 1837
- C. 1850
- D. 1887

Answer: B

Q4. Which year is taken as marking the close of the Age of Tennyson in this survey?

- A. 1887 (the year of Victoria's jubilee)
- B. 1901 (the year of Victoria's death)
- C. 1892 (the year of Tennyson's death)
- D. 1850 (the year Tennyson became Laureate)

Answer: A

Q5. How does the author describe the literature of the Age of Tennyson?

- A. Monotonous and purely classical
- B. Wonderfully rich and varied in personal quality
- C. Highly imitative of the Augustans
- D. Lacking in all social awareness

Answer: B

Q6. The literature of the Age of Tennyson everywhere embodies the spirit of:

- A. The French Revolution
- B. Victorian England
- C. The Renaissance
- D. The Protestant Reformation

Answer: B

Q7. The Victorian Age was an era of surprising change along many lines. What makes its literature unique?

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- A. It was written exclusively by women
- B. It could not conceivably have been produced at any other time in history
- C. It rejected the printing press
- D. It focused only on the medieval past

Answer: B

Q8. The enormous complexity of the Victorian period makes what impossible within brief limits?

- A. Exhaustive analysis
- B. Reading the poetry
- C. Naming the authors
- D. Understanding the language

Answer: A

Q9. Which two spheres are identified as containing the great dominant movements of the time?

- A. Military and naval
- B. Political/social and intellectual
- C. Artistic and musical
- D. Agricultural and industrial

Answer: B

Q10. In the political and social spheres, what was one of the two 'main currents' mentioned by Brandes?

- A. The decline of the monarchy
- B. The progress of democracy
- C. The rise of feudalism
- D. The suppression of parliament

Answer: B

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Page 218 - Political and Social Movements

Q1. Which Reform Bill had already destroyed the political supremacy of the landed aristocracy by the start of the Victorian era?

- A. The Reform Bill of 1867
- B. The Reform Bill of 1884
- C. The Reform Bill of 1832
- D. The Reform Bill of 1918

Answer: C

Q2. Why did the Reform Bill of 1832 fail to satisfy those pushing for a radical measure?

- A. It left the greater part of the laboring classes still un-enfranchised
- B. It abolished the monarchy
- C. It gave too much power to the King
- D. It banned trade unions

Answer: A

Q3. What great popular movement kept England in a state of political unrest for some ten years?

- A. Luddism
- B. Chartism
- C. Jacobitism
- D. Methodism

Answer: B

Q4. What term is used to describe the widespread misery of the 1840s?

- A. The roaring forties
- B. The hungry forties
- C. The golden forties
- D. The bleak forties

Answer: B

Q5. The first decade of the Queen's reign is described as an anxious time, but it stirred the social consciousness and gave impetus to:

- A. Imperial conquests
- B. Philanthropic energy and the spirit of humanitarianism
- C. The rise of the slave trade
- D. Military dictatorship

Answer: B

Q6. The repeal of which laws ushered in an era of much improved industrial conditions?

- A. The Poor Laws
- B. The Navigation Acts
- C. The Corn Laws
- D. The Test Acts

Answer: C

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Q7. After what year did the Chartist movement die out?

- A. 1832
- B. 1837
- C. 1848
- D. 1867

Answer: C

Q8. Tennyson sang the praises of England as a 'crown'd republic' due to what peaceful revolution?

- A. The execution of Charles I
- B. The Reform Bills of 1867 and 1884-85
- C. The Glorious Revolution of 1688
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: B

Q9. Beyond any other period in history, the Victorian Age was an age of:

- A. Epic poetry and tragedy
- B. Social interests and practical ideals
- C. Extreme political apathy
- D. Pure aestheticism

Answer: B

Q10. Whose works are cited as proof that much of Victorian literature was inspired by social interests and practical ideals?

- A. Keats, Shelley, Byron
- B. Carlyle, Ruskin, Dickens, Kingsley, and Mrs. Browning
- C. Pope, Swift, Defoe
- D. Wordsworth, Coleridge, Southey

Answer: B

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Page 219 - The Progress of Science

Q1. During the fifty years of the Victorian Age, the progress of science kept pace with the progress of what?

- A. Monarchy
- B. Democracy
- C. Feudalism
- D. Romanticism

Answer: B

Q2. How did the amount of positive knowledge added during this time compare to previous eras?

- A. It was less than the Renaissance
- B. It matched the Augustan age
- C. It was far more than in all the preceding eighteen centuries
- D. It declined significantly

Answer: C

Q3. How were the facts and speculations of experts spread to the public at large?

- A. By wandering minstrels
- B. Through popular education, newspapers, magazines, and cheap books
- C. Through royal decrees
- D. By traveling theatre troupes

Answer: B

Q4. What is identified as the greatest of all modern generalizations?

- A. The theory of relativity
- B. The doctrine of evolution
- C. The germ theory of disease
- D. The laws of thermodynamics

Answer: B

Q5. Which three names are specially associated with the doctrine of evolution in this text?

- A. Newton, Galileo, Kepler
- B. Darwin, Wallace, and Herbert Spencer
- C. Lyell, Faraday, Maxwell
- D. Huxley, Tyndall, Kelvin

Answer: B

Q6. What was the consequence of the rapid progress and popularization of knowledge on thought?

- A. Universal peace and religious harmony
- B. A vast upheaval in thought and shaking of the ancient intellectual order
- C. A return to medieval scholasticism
- D. The complete abandonment of science

Answer: B

Q7. The Victorian Age was marked throughout by the prominence of which spirit?

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- A. Unquestioning religious faith
- B. Inquiry, criticism, scepticism, and spiritual struggle
- C. Absolute political conformity
- D. Classical mythology

Answer: B

Q8. The analytical and critical habit of mind fostered by science resulted in a marked development of what in literature?

- A. Realism
- B. Fantasy
- C. Epic tragedy
- D. Pure romanticism

Answer: A

Q9. Which mechanical agencies are mentioned as breaking down barriers between town and country, and nation and nation?

- A. The printing press and the telescope
- B. The railway, the steamship, and the telegraph
- C. The automobile and the airplane
- D. The spinning jenny and the power loom

Answer: B

Q10. What did these mechanical agencies help to destroy?

- A. The monarchy
- B. The old provincialism
- C. The English language
- D. The universities

Answer: B

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Page 220 - Counter-Movement and Tennyson

Q1. What is an important principle of historical interpretation noted by the author regarding strong movements?

- A. They always last forever
- B. They always set up a counter-movement
- C. They eventually destroy society
- D. They only happen in political spheres

Answer: B

Q2. The great counter-movement in the Age of Tennyson was against the domination of:

- A. Poetry
- B. Democracy
- C. Science
- D. The monarchy

Answer: C

Q3. Science tended to materialism alike in thought and in life. How did a great deal of Victorian literature respond?

- A. By fully embracing materialism
- B. By desiring to check this tendency and proclaim the eternal value of spiritual things
- C. By ignoring science completely
- D. By returning to Latin and Greek

Answer: B

Q4. What was the prompting motive of the romantic revival during the Victorian era?

- A. A love for modern materialistic civilization
- B. Dissatisfaction with the ugliness of modern materialistic civilization
- C. A desire to write purely political pamphlets
- D. The intention to replace the novel with verse

Answer: B

Q5. In the end, the romantic spirit combined with the spirit of what, assuming a practical character?

- A. Social reform
- B. Scientific inquiry
- C. Classical translation
- D. Utilitarianism

Answer: A

Q6. Who are identified as the two chief poets of the Age of Tennyson?

- A. Keats and Shelley
- B. Tennyson and Browning
- C. Wordsworth and Coleridge
- D. Swinburne and Rossetti

Answer: B

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Q7. In what year was Alfred Tennyson born?

- A. 1798
- B. 1809
- C. 1832
- D. 1850

Answer: B

Q8. In 1829, Tennyson won the Chancellor's medal at Cambridge for a poem on what subject?

- A. Timbuctoo
- B. King Arthur
- C. Prometheus
- D. Waterloo

Answer: A

Q9. In what year did Tennyson become poet Laureate?

- A. 1832
- B. 1842
- C. 1850
- D. 1884

Answer: C

Q10. Whose death inspired Tennyson's philosophic elegy 'In Memoriam'?

- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Lord Byron
- C. His father
- D. His dear friend, Arthur Henry Hallam

Answer: D

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Page 221 - Tennyson's Works and Style

Q1. Which of the following is a monodrama published by Tennyson in 1854?

- A. The Princess
- B. Maud
- C. Enoch Arden
- D. In Memoriam

Answer: B

Q2. What overarching subject occupied Tennyson's attention for many years, culminating in a series of Idylls?

- A. The Greek gods
- B. The story of Arthur and the Round Table
- C. The history of the Roman Empire
- D. The life of Christ

Answer: B

Q3. For upwards of a decade, Tennyson devoted his energies mainly to which new field?

- A. The novel
- B. The essay
- C. The drama
- D. Political journalism

Answer: C

Q4. Which of the following is one of Tennyson's historical plays?

- A. King John
- B. Becket
- C. The Tempest
- D. Strafford

Answer: B

Q5. According to Tennyson's directions, which superb lyric is always printed as the last poem in any complete edition of his works?

- A. The Ancient Sage
- B. Vastness
- C. Akbar's Dream
- D. Crossing the Bar

Answer: D

Q6. Tennyson is considered perhaps the most conscientious and accomplished poetic artist in English literature after which poet?

- A. Chaucer
- B. Shakespeare
- C. Milton
- D. Pope

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Answer: C

Q7. What was Tennyson's relationship to his age from a strictly historical point of view?

- A. He was completely detached from it
- B. He was highly critical of all its movements
- C. He was the most thoroughly representative poet of his age
- D. He was largely ignored during his lifetime

Answer: C

Q8. To whom is Tennyson compared regarding his representative status for his respective era?

- A. Spenser to the England of Elizabeth
- B. Chaucer to the Middle Ages
- C. Milton to the Puritan Age
- D. Pope to the Augustan Age

Answer: A

Q9. The extraordinary diversity of Tennyson's work is typical of the strongly marked what of his age?

- A. Realism
- B. Eclecticism
- C. Absolutism
- D. Puritanism

Answer: B

Q10. Which poem from 1842 is full of the restless spirit of 'young England' and its faith in science and progress?

- A. Locksley Hall
- B. Locksley Hall Sixty Years After
- C. In Memoriam
- D. Maud

Answer: A